

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 246

By Hardaway

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Reverend Dr. Walter Womack.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Reverend Walter Womack of Memphis, a religious and civil rights leader, inspiring pastor, humble servant of God, and faithful friend; and

WHEREAS, beginning his work as a laborer in God's harvest in 1997, Reverend Womack began his first pastoral work in 1999 as an associate pastor under the direction of the late Pastor Paul F. Coleman at Soul Winners Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Womack then served as pastor at Faithful Baptist Church for approximately twenty-five years, laying a cornerstone that will be built upon for years to come, and in the ultimate testament to his generous selflessness as a shepherd, he tragically passed while consoling one of his congregants before a surgery; and

WHEREAS, he was known as a man of God and led his people, both longtime congregants and those who have newly entered into the fold, to discover the graces in this pilgrimage, and he confirmed and comforted his people in faith, whether marking the new beginnings of marriages or commemorating at funerals those who have fallen asleep; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Womack always did his utmost to foster his capacity for greater ministry, and he pursued additional studies at the Collierville School of Religion, Tennessee School of Religion, and Missionary Baptist Seminary, and he received certification to teach through the Pastor's Alternative Initiative and the Southern Christian Leadership Conference, where he also served as the president of the Memphis local chapter; and

WHEREAS, his positive spiritual influence spread far beyond the walls of Faithful Baptist Church with his appointment as the National Social Justice Committee chairman within the

National Baptist Convention, a position that served a four-state area, and through his over thirty-year membership with the Memphis Baptist Ministerial Association; and

WHEREAS, the state of our country's youth was a cause particularly dear to Reverend Womack's heart, and he set himself to advocate for their welfare with the American Federation for Children; and

WHEREAS, a consummate community servant, Reverend Womack always pushed for programs to help the disadvantaged and misfortunate of Memphis, establishing ministries for the unhoused, imprisoned, and young, and his leadership in clothing and food pantry drives, daily food pantries, back-to-school drives, blanket drives, health fairs, Big Brother mentorship programs, and job training programs have surely helped hundreds, if not thousands, of Memphians to see the love of God in their neighbor; and

WHEREAS, not unfamiliar with the daily toils of his flock, Reverend Womack also worked as a self-employed contractor with his own business, Womack's Painting and Tile, for over twenty-five years; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his good work from the pulpit and beyond, Reverend Womack was wholly devoted to his family and friends, especially his beloved wife of over twenty-five years, Deborah, and their four children; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Womack served his faith and his community with distinction for more than a quarter of a century, and he should be remembered for his many contributions and the example he set for others; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Reverend Dr. Walter Womack, reflecting fondly upon his resolute service to God and humanity, and extend our sympathy and condolences to his family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.